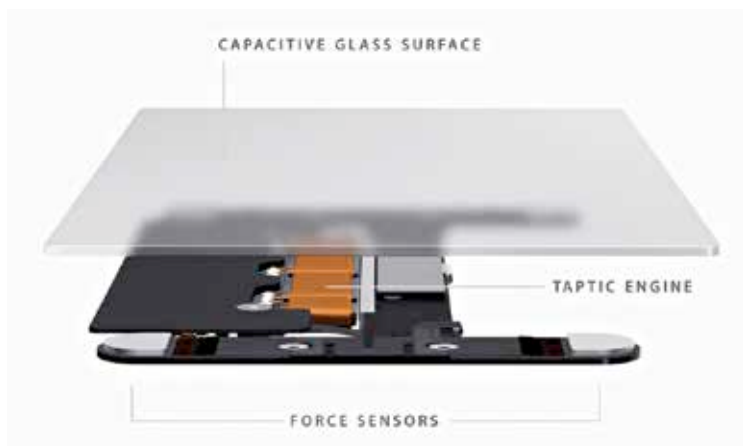


When Apple first announced Force Touch back in 2014 the new technology didn't exactly look groundbreaking. The features it offered back then seemed more gimmicky than useful. But three years later, this technology has had significant improvements, adopted a new name and works on multiple devices. In this chapter, let's take a quick dive into Apple's 3D Touch technology and find out how far it has permeated through the ecosystem.

What is Force Touch/3D Touch? (Hardware)

Pressure sensitive multi-touch technology (which is what the generic name for this input method is), marketed as Force Touch by Apple enables touchscreens and trackpads to sense different levels of force being applied. This technology provides new ways to access different controls within apps depending on the amount of pressure you apply to each tap.

Underneath the capacitive touch surface, are pressure sensors located evenly on all corners that can detect the subtle differences in the amount



What the internals of a pressure sensitive touch screen look like

of force being applied. The pressure sensors are then connected to a small device made up of a series of electrodes (Apple calls it the Taptic Engine) that can mimic a physical click of a trackpad using vibrations and also simulate a haptic feedback. With this technology, the trackpad can also be programmed to perform quick system or app actions by simply applying more pressure.